Acme Inc. Employee Handbook: HR Policy (v7)

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains how Acme Inc. manages working hours, leave, notice and remote work. It applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees. It does not apply to contractors, who are covered by their own service agreements.

2. Working hours

The standard working week is 40 hours, Monday to Friday, from 9:00 to 18:00 with a one-hour lunch break. Overtime must be approved in advance by your line manager and is paid at 1.5 times the hourly rate.

3. Annual leave

3.1 Entitlement

Every employee receives 20 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Leave is earned monthly, so new joiners receive a pro-rata share in their first year.

3.2 Carry over

Up to 5 unused days may be carried over to the next year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March, after which they are lost.

4. Sick leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. For absences longer than 3 consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered doctor is required.

5. Parental leave

5.1 Maternity leave

Birth mothers are entitled to 16 weeks of fully paid maternity leave.

5.2 Paternity leave

Fathers and partners are entitled to 2 weeks of fully paid paternity leave, to be taken within three months of the birth or adoption.

6. Notice

6.1 Notice periods

Permanent employees must give and receive a minimum of thirty (30) days' notice in writing. Longer periods may be agreed in individual contracts.

6.2 Probation

During probation, either side may end employment with one week's notice.

6.3 Garden leave

The company may ask an employee to stay away from work during the notice period while remaining on full pay.

6.4 Payment in lieu of notice

Payment in lieu of notice may only be made with the written approval of the HR Director. The approval must be kept on the employee's file.

7. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week with their manager's approval. Remote days cannot be carried over to the following week.

8. Policy owner

This policy is owned by the HR department and is reviewed every year. Version 7, effective 1 October 2026.